NCCP 00857 · VERSION 3

Pembrolizumab + carboplatin/paclitaxel → AC

Cycles 1–4: pembrolizumab and carboplatin on Day 1; paclitaxel on Days 1, 8 and 15. Cycles 5–8: pembrolizumab + doxorubicin/cyclophosphamide (AC) on Day 1 every 21 days. Surgery is followed by pembrolizumab when appropriate.

Draft — independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending. Selected effects; not a complete medicine leaflet.

A picture of side effects

Numbered symptom boxes connect to the anatomical illustration. The medicine responsible may be uncertain; report the symptom.

1 Hair / scalp

Taxane or AC chemotherapy

Hair loss or thinning varies. Ask about support and scalp cooling where appropriate.

2 Mouth

Chemotherapy

Painful ulcers or difficulty eating and drinking need advice.

3 Breathing

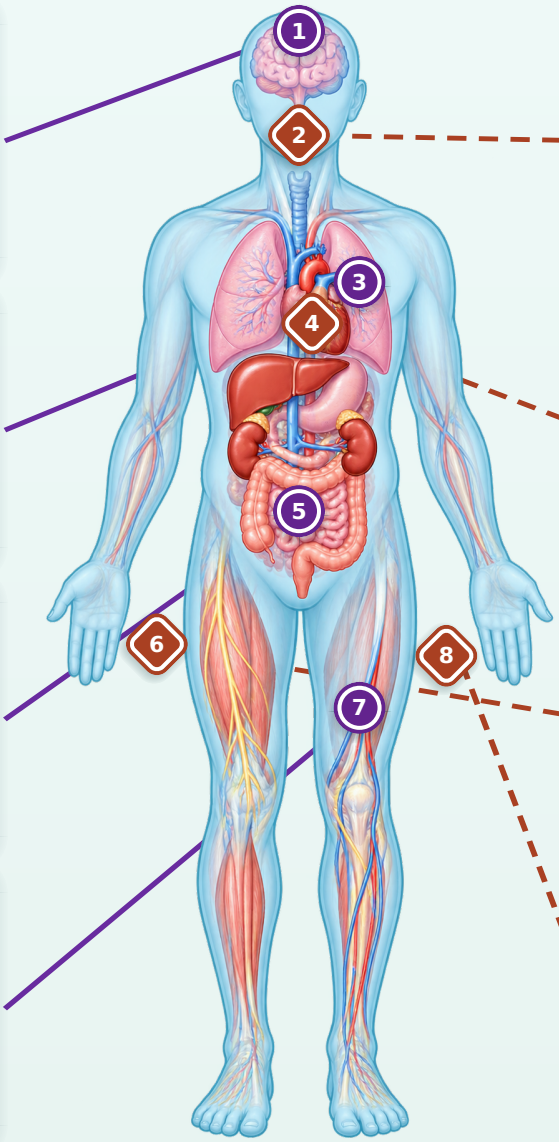
Pembrolizumab

New cough or breathlessness needs prompt assessment.

4 Heart / circulation

Doxorubicin / pembrolizumab

Fainting, chest pain or severe breathing difficulty: urgent help. Keep scheduled cardiac checks.



5 Bowel

Treatment medicines

Report diarrhoea early, especially with poor fluid intake, pain or fever.

6 Nerves / joints

Taxane chemotherapy

Report lasting numbness, painful joints or difficulty with daily activities.

7 Blood / infection

Chemotherapy and the whole regimen

Fever, shivers or suddenly unwell: contact oncology immediately.

8 Skin / liver symptoms

Pembrolizumab

Severe rash, blistering or yellow skin/eyes needs prompt advice.

Selected effects, not every possible effect or a prediction. Blood-count, skin and line markers are schematic. Number and text carry meaning; colour is decorative.

Fever, shivers or suddenly unwell: contact oncology immediately. Severe chest pain, breathing difficulty, collapse or seizure: 112 / 999.

Your treatment, at home.

Important medicine-specific effects

Pembrolizumab

- Immune inflammation of bowel, lungs, liver, kidneys or skin
- Hormone-gland problems, sometimes permanent
- Rare serious heart or neurological inflammation
- Infusion reaction
- Effects can first appear after treatment ends

Carboplatin

- Low blood counts, infection and bleeding
- Nausea, vomiting and fatigue
- Allergic reaction, sometimes after previous exposure
- Kidney or electrolyte changes

Paclitaxel

- Low blood counts and infection
- Numbness / tingling, sometimes lasting
- Hair loss, muscle or joint pain
- Infusion reaction
- Mouth, bowel, skin and nail effects

Doxorubicin

- Low counts, infection and mouth ulcers
- Nausea, hair loss and fatigue
- Heart damage, sometimes delayed
- Severe tissue injury if the infusion leaks
- Rare later blood cancers

Cyclophosphamide

- Low counts and infection
- Nausea, vomiting and hair loss
- Bladder irritation / bleeding
- Fertility effects and menopause
- Rare later blood cancers

Surgery, radiation and monitoring: open the whole-treatment map or scan the QR.

Make the plan practical

The phase matters

Premedicines, anti-sickness medicines and growth-factor plans may change when paclitaxel/carbo changes to AC.

Immune safety

Report new diarrhoea, breathlessness, rash, headache or marked fatigue, including after treatment ends.

Access and visits

Weekly visits in phase 1; every-three-week AC visits in phase 2. There is no routine home chemotherapy pump.

Recovery and fertility

Discuss fertility preservation before treatment and ask about scalp cooling, exercise and practical support.

Emergency: 112 / 999. Severe breathing difficulty, collapse, seizure or severe chest pain needs emergency help.

Contact oncology immediately for temperature ≥37.5°C or ≤36°C, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell, even with a normal temperature. Follow your own hospital's instructions. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment.

CUH · MON–FRI 8AM–5PM

087 181 9645

Acute Oncology Service

CUH · WEEKENDS / BANK HOLIDAYS 9AM–5PM

021 4922000

Ask for medical oncology

EVENINGS / OVERNIGHT

Your out-of-hours pathway / nearest ED

Other hospitals: use the numbers your team provides.

Complete reference, visual timeline and passport

https://sactcheck.com/patient/00857/

Sources and review status are available online. Follow your own prescription and hospital instructions.